



new year's resolutions: *developments at the ombudsman service and plans for 2012*

**Melissa Collett, ombudsman
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agenda – interactive!

- **publication of decisions - consultation**
- **PPI stats and funding**
- **recruitment and training**
- **complaints data**
- **non-disclosure stats**
- **further information**

publication of decisions

- **transparency agenda: Hunt Review**
- **new financial services bill**
- **all decisions to be published in 2013**
- **pilot scheme starting in 2012**
- **consumer's name redacted, but not business**
- **consultation ends tomorrow!**

your turn

- **how many of you responded to the consultation?**
- **how many of you think publication of decisions is a good thing?**
- **how many of you already use decisions as a learning tool?**

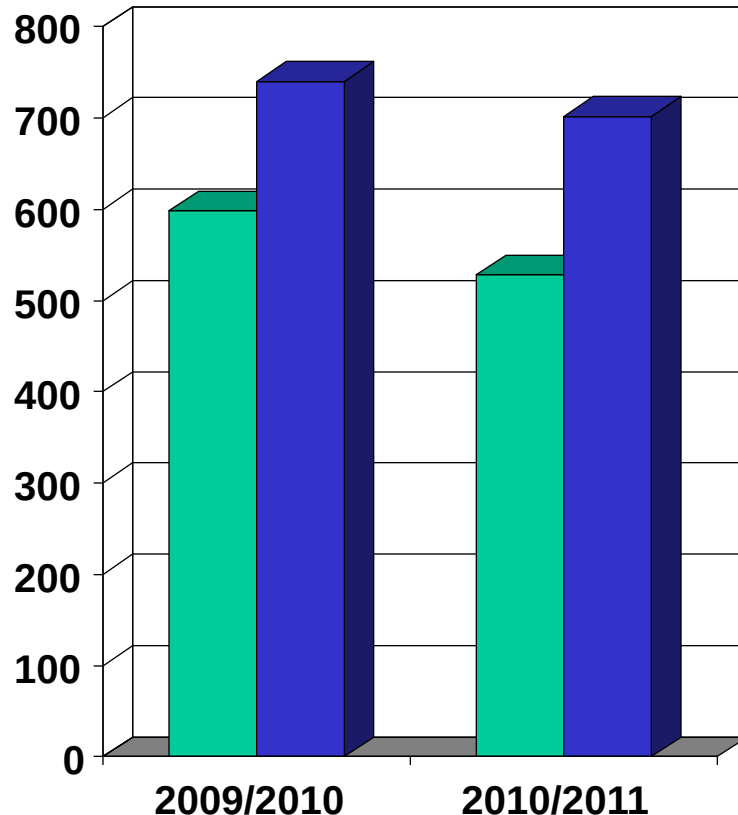
continuing saga of PPI

- **over 3,000 complaints per week!**
- **56% of our workload last year
(= over 100,000 complaints)**
- **9 out of 10 complaints upheld**
- **estimates for next year possibly double**
- **announcing new plans for funding in annual
plan & budget 2012**

recruitment and training

- continuing to recruit adjudicators, especially to deal with PPI
- adjudicator “academy”
- specialised medical training programme by product
- ongoing mentoring for 18 months +
- accredited training pilot: QMU
- ongoing training – casework advisers

protection insurance stats



- 528 critical illness complaints in 2010/11 (down 18% from 598 in 2009/10)
- 702 income protection complaints in 2010/11 (down 5% from 740 in 2009/10)
- added together still 1/100th of number of PPI complaints!
- also much less than complaints about travel (2,503), buildings (3,469) and motor (5,784)

 critical illness  income protection

complaints data

- published in Sept'11, shows complaint numbers and uphold rates for first six months 2011
- average uphold rate is 47%
- out of 17 protection insurers, only 4 exceeded 40% uphold rate, only one exceeded 50% (most around 33%)
- prize for lowest upheld rate of 24% goes to ...
- have you seen this data?

non-disclosure stats

- **ABI data: 2% overall decline rate due to ND (down from 8% pre-Code)**
- **few complaints referred: c10% of declines**
- **complaints about non-disclosure minimal (152 cases in 2010)**
- **no difference in approach after introduction of Code to categorisation and collection of medical evidence**
- **ND now going in right direction**

top tips for managing IP claims

- **burden on proof on business on termination**
- **consideration of GP evidence and treatment**
- **IMEs with most appropriate specialist**
- **termination without rehabilitation**
- **proportionate/rehab benefit rarely used**
- **new consideration to state disability assessment**

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any questions?